



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 6

COLORADO

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Colorado's family courts and child-welfare system.

60

COLORADO FAMILIES ON RECORD ·
66 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 24
MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF
PARENTING TIME

REPORT GENERATED

MAY 3, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED

21 OF 64

COMPILED BY

MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

COLORADO AT A GLANCE.

Across 60 Colorado families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 66 60 of 60 families reported child counts	MEDIAN FAMILY IMPACT \$154,000 total cost across all expense categories	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 24 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 70.0% 31.7% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 60	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.1	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 60 of 60	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 21

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Colorado families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF COLORADO FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	29	\$20,000	\$95,172	\$2,760,000
Lost Wages	31	\$50,000	\$259,891	\$8,056,610
Other Court Fees	25	\$2,000	\$12,108	\$302,700
Therapy / Evaluations	27	\$3,000	\$13,941	\$376,420
Reunification Services	24	\$1,250	\$7,587	\$182,080
GAL Fees	22	\$0	\$1,741	\$38,300
Asset Loss ¹	32	\$82,500	—	—
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$154,000	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$82,500) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		24	2 yrs
Mean months lost		51	4.2 yrs
Total across all families		1,789	149.1 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · COLORADO

Most families documenting in Colorado are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		28	47%
Not provided		16	27%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		11	18%
Case closed: within last 2 years		4	7%
Active case: progress being made		1	2%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Family Court Only		23	38%
Both Family Court and CPS		20	33%
Unknown		12	20%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		5	8%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		17	28%
Over 10 years		11	18%
5 – 10 years		8	13%
3 – 5 years		6	10%
5+ years		6	10%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		22	37%
Visitation Only		14	23%
50/50 Joint		9	15%
Full Custody		7	12%
Partial / Shared		3	5%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

El Paso		6	10%
Weld		4	7%
Arapahoe		4	7%
Douglas		4	7%
Jefferson		3	5%
Larimer		3	5%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		18	30%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		9	15%
High Conflict Divorce		6	10%
Child Protective Services (CPS / DCF)		6	10%
Other: (Short answer)		4	7%

04 PARENT VOICES — COLORADO

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Colorado comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



Magistrates are on the take in Colorado, to become a judge. If you report misconduct or Brady violations they retaliate on you. CPS is a joke, they all use their in house counsel to solve issues and are connected with other attorneys. Attorneys are notified if CPS is called or [...]

— COLIN

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

Torn us apart. Lack of due process nearly destroyed a close relationship between mother and son

— COLORADO PARENT · ANONYMOUS

MORE VOICES FROM COLORADO

The system has destroyed my son. ,my Family my life my finances, and my local welding business .,My son was ripped away from his aunt ,brothers, cousins, community , friends and school and me his father, and moved 540 miles away. All based upon false allegations ,and proven lies [...]

— KENNETH

For over 14 months, my sons' futures have been treated as collateral damage in a scorched-earth strategy where a "childlike" need for control has replaced actual parenting. What is being called "maternal security" is actually a calculated act of deception. This "single mother" [...]

— JUSTIN

CPS was not there to help even after repeated reports of abuse and DV. The court still allows the children time with their abusive father even after findings of abuse, coercive control and DV was made. The court is allowing legal and financial abuse to continue as well as [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Absolute destruction, trauma, abuse, financial ruin. Incarceration.

— RYAN

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Separated and destroyed siblings bonding and growing up together. Traumatizing children and retraumatizing the adult who was abused by vindictive adopted parents.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has traumatized my kids and myself in ways that I believe are irreparable

— CHARLENE

Family court is where the Constitution of the United States is best used to wipe ones ass, Judges and attorneys know it, lies and false accusations are normal and truth does not matter.

— MIKE

Freedom of speech doesn't exist with CPS. I sent an email asserting my parental rights, then I lost everything that I love in this world. 12 straight years of being a single father-did not matter

— SAMUEL

This system didn't just separate me from my children—it took years of love, connection, and memories we can never replace.

— ALYSSA

It's destroyed me inside and out.

— KASSY

I have lost everything due to the system and how it treats fathers. Child support alone has kept me homeless fkr a decade of my life despite me working full time. The system incentivizes conflict and separation of families without regard for who it's hurting. The judges and [...]

— JASON

I had to bury a child and and was kept from protecting my other two older children from abuse for 15 years, I lost my relationship with my children altogether, and was deprived from being a mother forever.

— ALISHIA

Legalized abuse. Kidnapped and tortured childhood and parenthood. Created everlasting trauma for child and safe parent. There truly are not words. Humanitarian Crisis for profit. Pure Evil.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Destroyed us and caused trauma and damages for our future

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system failed my children and protected a narcissist mom

— ANDREW

Stripped me of my title as a mom

— MIRANDA

Stolen my son, violating rights to safety and love for both of us. I waited to be a mom, and didn't want to miss any of it but now I'm prevented from all and he's in a home of horror.

— MARY

Put me in jail, emotionally traumatized me and my daughter, and had to start my life completely over from scratch.

— CHRIS

Destroyed my relationship with my child and enabled my abuser to continue abusing myself using the system as their tool. Have suffered irreparable physical, mental, and financial harm.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Used the system to take the one thing that would hurt me to lose.

— AMANDA

Kidnapped my sons, tortured them, punished them for speaking up about it. Took two more of my kids years after to break my spirit. One daughter is still missing. My son thinks I'm "bad" because the mother got paid off in lawsuits and the attorney we hired to sue them was my ex [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

These experiences deeply traumatized our family, undermined our stability, and forced us to live in constant crisis-management mode. Instead of focusing on healing and growth, we were consumed by defending ourselves and trying to survive broken systems.

— MICHELLE

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



The system destroyed my family and now as my adult daughter still deals with the repercussions to this day, I know something needs to be done now to stop this!

— AMANDA

The system left me living in a camper while rewarding the man who harmed us, and taught my daughters to value resources over safety.

— JULIE

Denied justice due process and it cost me everything. Now I feel like I'm being harassed by child support.

— MARK

The system continues to show me that it is all about the money who has it who can pay more. The best interest of children is not at the forefront of the court.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This family court rewarded parental alienation, restricted my relationship with my children, and gave sole decision-making authority to the parent creating barriers to our bond, despite evidence of withheld parenting time, denied contact, and gatekeeping. At the same time, it [...]

— ANDREW

The system tried to kill me and erase my from my child's life. My ex manipulated my own family and tried to get them to testify against me as harshly as possible so as to do th most damage that he possibly could. My son was only three years old and was ripped away from me. I was [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It's made me feel like I'm not a Good Mother. Even though I know I do my best as a Single Mother. It's Harassing me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Separated us,.... Lives and memories lost,... Its affected my health tremendously Iv always thought they placed her with Unsafe people they have a criminal background and guns in there homes I put photos in my book the missing that shows photos of my daughter near guns they have [...]

— LINDSEY

They broke us when we looked to them for a voice of reason... Lied cheated and stole under the color or law

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Complete destruction of ability to thrive, depleting my parents retirement savings, extreme constant stress to child, me, my parents my siblings and their children. Straining and diminishing any/all meaningful relationships as this is too much for anyone close to hear in detail [...]

— AUBREE

Taking my daughter as an infant, when her father was absent. Not taking breastfeeding seriously, or developmental needs. Ignoring doctors and specialists. Ignoring evidence of substance use around child and witness testimony.

— JANELLE

The Magistrate belittled me for an hour at the last hearing. Threatening to take my child away from me because I wasn't "flexable". All because I was following the court order. No where can anyone show me a law or state statute that mandates me to be flexible instead in leu of a [...]

— KELLEY

The system is built on, whoever makes the loudest accusations or has the most money I came to court with timeline, documented evidence, and proof of competence... it was dismissed and I was restricted even after proof through DHS clearing me NO FINDINGS.

— EVELYNN

it has ruined my family's dynamic, we used to be close and now all of us have a form of ptsd and are experiencing that in the courts. we do not trust these caseworkers to ever do their jobs properly.

— PRISCILLA

38 Colorado parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 38 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — COLORADO

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Colorado families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

Magistrates are on the take in Colorado, to become a judge. If you report misconduct or Brady violations they retaliate on you. CPS is a joke, they all use their in house counsel to solve issues and are connected with other attorneys. Attorneys are notified if CPS is called or reported to and investigations are shut down. Police records have been deleted and IA had to be conducted in order to solve the issue of deletion; however no actions were taken in our cases. Douglas and Arapahoe County had to be separated so they couldn't shift their magistrates and judges to hide them from their Brady violations. They is a huge network of broken system thugs that are here for the money but not best interest of your children. CFI, PREs are a joke. PRE sexually assaulted another, lied and abused its power and the county called him a reputable firm and to not talk about him in that disrespectful manner. Zero continuity in cases with magistrates where if they screw up or realize they have been lied to they leave your case, I've been through 15 magistrates and one judge. In the end the system is a joke, politicians want you to know they care but they don't protect your kids and most philosophy's are in place not laws to protect children. Look up divorce marketing magazine, where you see professionals share their testimony's prior to court to gain business from other attorneys. Hard to take down a fraudulent billion dollar business plan supported by politicians because they are the ones appointing the magistrates from property law.

— COLIN

The system has destroyed my son. ,my Family my life my finances, and my local welding business .,My son was ripped away from his aunt ,brothers, cousins, community , friends and school and me his father, and moved 540 miles away. All based upon false allegations ,and proven lies by a corrupt judge Furse and his pedofile friend Don Wilson the sheriff.

— KENNETH

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

For over 14 months, my sons' futures have been treated as collateral damage in a scorched-earth strategy where a "childlike" need for control has replaced actual parenting. What is being called "maternal security" is actually a calculated act of deception. This "single mother" act is a fraud; she hasn't been left alone—she has intentionally forced the father out to prioritize her own emotional grievances. She has kept this case open for 14 months by perpetually manufacturing new "safety concerns" every time the old ones are proven false, stalling any hope of progress to protect her own image. My reactive responses are not the cause of this conflict; they are the direct result of having the truth suppressed for an entire year. She carries this on because she would rather burn the whole house down than engage in the self-reflection and growth required to provide a stable home. To admit the truth now would be to admit she spent a year traumatizing her own sons for a personal vendetta while dismissing her own destructive behavior. The reality is simple: I am not a threat to my sons, and I am not a threat to Elizabeth. I am only a threat to the narrative she has built. You don't protect your children by erasing their father; you protect your own ego by erasing the truth, even if it means destroying the very foundation they were supposed to stand on.

— JUSTIN

CPS was not there to help even after repeated reports of abuse and DV. The court still allows the children time with their abusive father even after findings of abuse, coercive control and DV was made. The court is allowing legal and financial abuse to continue as well as coercive control and mental abuse through family therapy and visits. Children's rights, wishes and best interests are not followed but instead the abuser gets rights while his victims are scrutinized.

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It's destroyed me inside and out.

— KASSY

I have lost everything due to the system and how it treats fathers. Child support alone has kept me homeless fkr a decade of my life despite me working full time. The system incentivizes conflict and separation of families without regard for who it's hurting. The judges and magistrates that enable these things should be made to forfeit their places to live despite the contents of their bank accounts to see how it feels. Its unforgivable to hurt children and loving parents for personal profits and state revenue. Disgusting.

— JASON

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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This family court rewarded parental alienation, restricted my relationship with my children, and gave sole decision-making authority to the parent creating barriers to our bond, despite evidence of withheld parenting time, denied contact, and gatekeeping. At the same time, it imposed financial orders based on unsupported income assumptions that created impossible obligations, pushing me into debt while weakening my ability to remain a stable and present father in my children's lives.

— ANDREW

The system tried to kill me and erase my from my child's life. My ex manipulated my own family and tried to get them to testify against me as harshly as possible so as to do th most damage that he possibly could. My son was only three years old and was ripped away from me. I was a stay at home mom for most of his life by that point. I had only just begun to go back to school and work when my ex and I separated. My son was still breastfeeding and my mother and grandmother do not act in good faith, they covertly chose to side against me because my ex had the money. My mom secretly also was trying to take my son for her own even though that was never even up for discussion. Also my mom's boyfriend at the also testified against me as a police officer because he was mad I didn't let my mom borrow my car to visit him in the middle of the night during a snowstorm. My reliable vehicle was my only way to get to and from work at the time so I could pay my attorney fees and I could not let her take it.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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— PRISCILLA

38 full approved Colorado comments are included in this appendix.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Colorado report comes from Colorado respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Colorado — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 60 Colorado families reporting here are not the universe of Colorado families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – May 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte-Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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